

Part 1: General Overview

The DIMACS program was an awesome and highly valuable experience. I want to thank Professor Gallos and Larry for doing such a wonderful job with the organization; their efforts made all the difference. The best part for me was the people. The game nights and movie nights were a great way to bond, and I really enjoyed getting to know everyone.

On the academic side, I grew immensely. My research project in geometry and topology was tough for me at first since it's an area I'm less familiar with. But over time, I started to get a real handle on the problem and became much more interested in the subject. My mentors, Professor Feng Luo, Professor Hongbin Sun, Dr. Zhenghao Rao, and Mr. Kuijin Liu, played a huge role in that. I couldn't have made that progress without their guidance.

Part 2: Practical Details

While I loved the program, I have a few suggestions that I think could make it even better.

My main feedback relates to the seminars. I was hoping for a more even split between math and theoretical computer science topics. The seminars are meant to give us a broad view of current research, and while I learned a lot about what's happening in TCS, I didn't get as clear a picture of the math side. The talks themselves were great, but the overall balance could be improved.

I also think that adding a few more planned group activities would be a great way to help everyone get to know each other even better.

Finally, the program felt a little short! A lot of us were just hitting our stride and feeling real research momentum when it was time to wrap up. An extra week or two would have made a huge difference in how far we could push our projects.